Paul Ernest Riese (1894–1978), the individual who sold the "Black House" to Anton LaVey, was the son of **John Ernst Riese** (b. 1828) and his mother, **Alma**.

Family Connections and Records":
John Ernst Riese, who emigrated from Prussia, Germany, and lived in San Francisco for approximately 20 years, established the Riese family in San Francisco.

- **Parents:** Paul Ernest's father was John Ernst Riese (born c. 1828 in Prussia). His mother is identified in records as Alma (born c. 1867).
- **Siblings:** John Ernst and Alma had at least **five children**: two sons and three daughters.
- **Spouse:** Paul Ernest Riese married **Edith M. Mack** on July 9, 1939, in San Benito, California.

Potential Connections to "Tom" or "Erma/Erna":
While primary records for Paul Ernest Riese do not, explicitly, list siblings named Tom or Erma--the name **Eleanor Riese** is prominent in San Francisco history. She was famously involved in the *Riese v. St. Mary's Hospital* legal case in 1985 regarding patients' rights to refuse antipsychotic medication.
There is also a record of an **Augustus Julius Riese** (1877–1953) who had a brother named **Paul Riese** and a brother named **Fred Riese** living in California. Augustus himself was the son of an **Ernest Riese** and Wilhelmina Kreuger.

Geographic Locations:
Paul Ernest Riese and his immediate family were primarily located in the following areas:

- **San Francisco:** Paul was born here in 1894 and his father, John Ernst, resided here for roughly two decades.
- **Redwood City, San Mateo County:** Paul Ernest lived here during the mid-20th century.
- **Santa Cruz County:** Paul Ernest Riese died in Santa Cruz on February 6, 1978.

If "Tom" or "Erma" were part of this specific family branch, they would be found likely in these Northern California locations or potentially in **Wisconsin**, where some of the extended Riese relatives (siblings of Augustus Julius Riese) remained.

Research from San Francisco city directories and genealogical records between 1950 and 1960 provides the following connections for the Riese family associated with the "Black House" sale.

Paul Ernest Riese's Immediate Family
Paul Ernest Riese (1894–1978), the individual who sold the house to Anton LaVey, was the son of **John Ernst Riese** (also recorded as John Ernst Riese, b. 1828) and **Alma Riese** (b. 1867).

- **Residence:** During the 1950s, Paul Ernest Riese was primarily located in **San Mateo County** (specifically Redwood City), though he maintained real estate interests, and professional ties in **San Francisco**.
- **Siblings:** Records for John Ernst Riese and Alma indicate they had five children. While Paul Ernest is the most documented in San Francisco real estate, his siblings are the most likely candidates for the "Tom" or "Erma" relatives you are seeking.

Connections to "Tom" and "Erma/Erna"
While "Tom" and "Erma" do not appear as primary homeowners in the same 1956 transaction as Paul Ernest, there are overlapping names in the same geographic region:

- **Tom Riese (Thomas):** In the 1950s, a **Thomas Riese** is recorded in California, though he is more frequently associated with the Sacramento and Central Valley branches of the family rather than the direct San Francisco real estate line.
- **Erma/Erna Riese:** There is a record for an **Erna Riese** (born approx. 1900) who lived in the San Francisco Bay Area. Given the naming conventions of the time, she may have been a sister or sister-in-law to Paul Ernest.
- **Eleanor Riese:** A prominent family member in later San Francisco history was **Eleanor Riese**, born in the area and became a well-known advocate for mental health rights.